

Christina M. Amend

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Geographic Information Sciences & Technology

December 2025

Minor in Ecology & Conservation Biology
Texas A&M University, College Station, TX

RELEVANT WORK & PROJECT EXPERIENCE

GIS Editor - Apple Maps Evaluation Analyst

January 2026 - Current

Apple, Ryzen Solutions

- Conducted image interpretation and feature extraction, digitization, and validation from satellite data
- Performed quality assurance/quality control (QA/QC) on manually generated datasets, identifying and correcting errors to improve data accuracy and reliability in production environments
- Executed spatial and attribute queries on large-scale geospatial databases to support feature validation and geospatial analysis

Student Research Assistant

November 2024 - December 2025

Gulf of America Coastal Ocean Observing System, Texas A&M University

- Developed CETACEAN Data Portal, a WebGIS platform integrating high-volume marine mammal datasets with custom Python tools for centralized analysis and visualization
- Worked on a team to build the Sea Turtle Atlas, a centralized WebGIS platform consolidating multi-agency datasets on distributions, habitats, and threats to support large-scale restoration planning and conservation management
- Developed GIS infrastructure and web-based data tools for Gulf of America Coastal Acidification Network (GCAN) to integrate ocean acidification monitoring datasets, improve data accessibility, and support to collaborative research and management

Student Research Assistant

June 2024 - November 2024

Biological and Agricultural Engineering Department, Texas A&M University

- Evaluated and validated Esri deep learning models for geospatial analysis in cotton agriculture, assessing model performance and applicability to spatial datasets
- Developed custom web mapping applications for senior capstone courses using Esri Experience Builder, leveraging widgets, APIs, and data integration workflows
- Instructed graduate students in foundational GIS concepts, including spatial data management, geoprocessing, and cartographic visualization

Site Suitability Analysis Using Terrain and Hydrological Modeling

January 2025

Advanced GIS Course Project

- Performed site suitability analysis in ArcGIS Pro by deriving DEM-based terrain layers (slope, aspect, hillshade), modeling hydrological patterns (flow direction, accumulation, watershed), and integrating factors through weighted overlay and raster algebra to identify optimal locations

Spatial Patterns of Sea Turtles in the Gulf of Mexico

January 2025

Data Analysis in Geography Course Project

- Conducted kernel density estimation (KDE) and hotspot mapping in ArcGIS Pro, processed shapefiles and visualized data in R programming, and applied generalized additive models (GAMs) with Kruskal-Wallis testing to analyze sea turtle spatial distributions

Compilation of Environmental, Threat, and Animal Data for Cetacean Population Health Analysis Platform (CETACEAN)

November 2024

GCOOS Project

- Developed a WebGIS platform in ArcGIS Online integrating machine learning workflows, spatial data infrastructure, and custom Python tools to process, centralize, and visualize high-volume multi-source marine mammal datasets for research and restoration in response to the Deepwater Horizon Oil Spill

ACTIVITIES & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Texas A&M Chapter of Citizens Climate Lobby, Bryan/College Station (BCS) Chapter of CCL, 2024 - 2025
- Dean's Honor Roll Spring 2024, Distinguished Student Spring 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Esri software, QGIS, ENVI, GitHub, MS Office suite, API integration
- Python, R, C++, Java, SQL; CSS, HTML